

Brad Lavender

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DevOps, Platform Engineering & Infra as Code IT professional with 9+ years of experience and broad skillsets utilizing a variety of tech tools. Skills built on a full-stack background with heavy reliance on C#, golang & React. Leverages agentic AI & prompt engineering to enhance productivity and problem-solving capabilities.

DevOps Developer — Hunter Engineering Co

July 2021 - Now

At Hunter, DevOps is IT for IT. Essentially, we work for the Enterprise Architect to solution anything that anyone doesn't know how to do. We hold the keys to many kingdoms and use them to solve problems. It's 60% Platform Engineering, 25% Developer Support & 15% SRE.

- Providing DevOps practices and methodologies across development teams
- Implementing comprehensive monitoring and alerting strategies
- Automating infrastructure provisioning and deployment processes
- Optimizing cloud resource utilization and cost management

Application Software Developer — Centene

February 2020 - July 2021

Life at Centene was operating in your team's borders and coordinating with the other teams that produce to or consume from your domain. Lots of bureaucracy, guardrails & constraints.

- Assimilated Golang, MongoDB, DevOps concepts & learned a variety of new software to start working tickets independently within 2 months
- Served as point of contact for external reporting team's data target migration from SQL to mongo collections
- Developed back-end APIs in Golang in CI/CD environment porting information via Kafka from SQL to MongoDB
- Navigated enormous monolithic corporate environment with many small teams
- Supported Prod API consumers and served as point of contact for teams publishing data sources & Kafka topics
- Tuned existing stored procedures for team's APIs
- Audited indexes used in mongo collections

Technology Summary

DevOps & Cloud

- Azure DevOps *Admin*
- Azure *Subscription Owner*
- Docker
- Kubernetes
- Jenkins
- Kafka

Infrastructure as Code

- Pulumi *Admin*
- Terraform
- Azure ARM / Bicep

AI & Automation

- GitHub Copilot
- Prompt Engineering
- AI-Assisted Development

Languages

- C#
- Golang
- Java
- js/ts
- PowerShell
- HTML
- CSS
- React

Full Stack Web Developer — Motivation Technologies

January 2017 - February 2020

Motech's IT department was 15-20 Developers empowered to transform the Creative department's dreams into realities sold by the Accounts department. Projects were usually short-lived, promotional efforts that leveraged a 15-year old, monolithic, home-grown codebase for some of the heavy lifting.

- Wrote the first React project for the company
- Implemented & supported promotional pages - from single page, 1/2 day projects to \$250K multi-month projects
- Data-modeling & organizational planning around Account Department driven business rules
- Matching Creative department mock-ups across responsive breakpoints for the front end
- Polishing page behavior or data submission as needed with TypeScript or vanilla JS
- Handled Reporting - from single-use throw-away scripts to programmatically controlled multi-page daily reports
- Dealt with 29 different CultureCodes in a responsive design environment
- Created, maintained & supported MVC systems
- Developed new & utilized existing APIs
- Created, updated, indexed SQL tables
- Learned some basics of DevOps - HAProxy, load balancing, what happens during a deployment
- Explored adapting TDD methodologies into existing development practices

Personal Interests

Outside of work I enjoy a variety of hands-on and outdoor activities that keep me creative and problem-solving:

Parenting

Combat robotics

Mechanical
keyboards

DIY / making

3D printing

3D modeling

Woodworking

Rock climbing

Slacklining

Disc golf

Databases

- SQL
- MongoDB

Monitoring & Logging

- Datadog *Admin*
- Elastic *Admin*
- Prometheus
- Grafana

Version Control

- git
- HG (Mercurial)

Tools & Testing

- Postman *Admin*
- Swagger
- SonarQube *Admin*
- QwietAI *Admin*

API Architecture

- REST
- GraphQL
- GRPC